

Billy Leet

Product researcher who changes the question.

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UX researcher with **8+ years of hands-on research and leadership** at Instagram and Duolingo. I lead ambiguous, high-stakes work from foundational framing through product direction, combining deep qualitative research, surveys, diary studies, and behavioral evidence. Former speech-language pathologist; trained to notice the gap between what people intend and what they can express.

my throughline ←

Generative research, mixed methods, and influence that helps teams rethink what they are building.

selected experience

Independent



UX Research Consultant · Change.org

Feb 2025–present

- Owned foundational research on unusually effective petition sharers, partnering with data science on behavioral sampling; reframed the strategy around removing friction for already-motivated supporters, resulting in commitments to two progress-feedback MVPs.

Duolingo



May 2021–Feb 2025

Sr UX Research Manager · Oct 2022–Feb 2025

Staff UX Researcher · Jul–Oct 2022 · **Senior UX Researcher** · May 2021–Jul 2022

- Owned research strategy as the sole UXR through the learning-path redesign's formative phases, sequencing 10+ studies and bringing learner evidence into weekly reviews with the CEO, CPO, VP Engineering, Head of Design, and product leads; research prompted explicit progress reassurance in re-onboarding.
- Created Rolling Research, a largely self-sustaining weekly usability program adopted across Growth, Learning, and Monetization; scaled it to two dedicated contract researchers and enabled repeated iteration on copy, design, and product choices.
- Promoted from Senior to Staff, then managed and developed five researchers while remaining hands-on as a player-coach on critical initiatives.

Instagram



Jun 2018–May 2021

Senior UX Researcher · Feb–May 2021

UXR II · Sep 2020–Feb 2021 · **UXR I** · Sep 2019–Sep 2020 · **Associate UXR** · Jun 2018–Sep 2019

- Served as Instagram's primary creator researcher across Feed, Messenger, Profile, and Live, shaping strategy on safety, audience relationships, analytics, and monetization.
- Owned survey design, programming, analysis, and presentation for a Live study with 400+ creators; translated findings into a cross-functional workshop that fed quarterly planning.
- Concept testing surfaced false-positive and anxiety concerns that shaped a shipped safety feature; a What/Why/How framework continued guiding creator-insights work after I left.

Google



Apr 2016–May 2018

UX Research Coordinator, Google Cloud · Apr 2017–May 2018

Copyright Associate, YouTube · Apr 2016–Apr 2017

- Supported study planning, recruiting, fieldwork, analysis, and research communication; advised teams on survey design and developer-focused research.

earlier chapter

Speech, language & communication · 2013–18

Clinical training across pediatric and adult communication—including aphasia, voice, and Deaf/Hard-of-Hearing settings—plus a private accent-coaching practice for multilingual professionals.

education

McGill University – M.Sc.A., Communication Sciences & Disorders

University of Pittsburgh — B.A., Linguistics & French

research toolkit

Strategy: foundational & generative research, product strategy, roadmap influence, research programs

Methods: in-depth interviews, usability & concept testing, diary & longitudinal studies, surveys, mixed methods

Leadership: executive communication, facilitation, mentoring, team development, player-coach leadership

Languages: English (native), French (full professional), ASL (professional working)